



Licensing Sub-Committee

MINUTES of the OPEN section of the Licensing Sub-Committee held on Tuesday 27 January 2026 at 10.00 am at Online/Virtual

PRESENT: Councillor Renata Hamvas (Chair)
Councillor Dora Dixon-Fyle MBE
Councillor Barrie Hargrove

OFFICER SUPPORT: Toyin Calfos, legal officer
Andrew Heron, licensing officer
Andrew Weir, constitutional officer

1. APOLOGIES

This was a virtual licensing sub-committee meeting.

The chair explained to the participants and observers how the virtual meeting would run. Everyone then introduced themselves.

There were no apologies for absence.

2. CONFIRMATION OF VOTING MEMBERS

The voting members were confirmed verbally, one at a time.

3. NOTIFICATION OF ANY ITEMS OF BUSINESS WHICH THE CHAIR DEEMS URGENT

There were none.

4. DISCLOSURE OF INTERESTS AND DISPENSATIONS

There were none.

5. LICENSING ACT 2003: PECKHAM PALAIS, 1A RYE LANE, LONDON SE15 5EW

It was noted that this item had been postponed to 19 February 2026, to allow for further conciliation.

6. LICENSING ACT 2003: KENT RESTAURANT AND LOUNGE, FIRST FLOOR, 516 OLD KENT ROAD, LONDON SE1 5BA

It was noted that this item had been withdrawn by the applicant.

7. LICENSING ACT 2003: LA HUECA LIMITED, 220 OLD KENT ROAD, LONDON SE1 5UB

The licensing officer advised that neither the applicant nor the other person objecting would be attending the meeting.

The licensing officer presented their report. Members had questions for the licensing officer.

The meeting adjourned at 10.21am for the sub-committee to consider its decision.

The meeting reconvened at 10.43am and the chair read out the decision of the sub-committee.

RESOLVED:

That the application made by Hugo Santiago Garzon Plua for a premises licence to be granted under the Licensing Act 2003 in respect of the premises known as La Hueca Limited, 220 Old Kent Road, London SE1 5UB is granted as follows:

Supply of Alcohol (on Sales)	Monday to Sunday from 10:00 to 23:00
Regulated entertainment – recorded music	Monday to Sunday from 09:00 to 23:00
Opening hours	Monday to Sunday from 07:00 to 23:30

Conditions

The operation of the premises under the licence shall be subject to relevant mandatory conditions, conditions derived from the operating schedule highlighted in A, B, E, F, G, H, J, K, L, and M of the application form and the conditions agreed with the Metropolitan Police Service

Conditions agreed with the Metropolitan Police Service

1. That a CCTV system shall be installed and maintained in full working order. The CCTV system will record footage of high definition evidential quality in all lighting conditions and should be able to capture a clear facial image of all persons that enter the venue. All public areas will be covered by the CCTV system including the bar, smoking areas, and frontage of the premises. The CCTV system shall be correctly time and date stamped at all times. The premises shall not be open at any time when the CCTV is not operating correctly.
2. That all CCTV footage shall be kept for a period of thirty one (31) days and shall be made immediately available for inspection to officers of the Police and the Council on request.
3. That at least one member of staff should be on duty at all times the premises is open that is trained in the use of the CCTV and able to view and download images to a removable device or digitally transferred on request of police officers and authorised council officers.
4. That all staff shall be trained in their responsibilities under the Licensing Act 2003 and in regards to the terms and conditions of this licence. Such training should include the prevention of sales of alcohol to underage persons, and the challenge 25 scheme in operation at the premises. Records pertaining to such training shall be kept / be accessible at the premises at all times, shall be updated every 6 months and shall be made immediately available for inspection at the premises to police officers and authorised council officers.
5. That clearly legible signs shall be prominently displayed where they can easily be seen and read by customers at all exits from the premises, requesting to the effect that customers leave the premises and area in a quiet and orderly manner. Such signs shall be maintained free from obstruction when the premises are in use in accordance with this licence.
6. That a dispersal policy to assist with patrons leaving the premises in an orderly and safe manner shall be devised and maintained regarding the premises. A copy of the dispersal policy shall be accessible at the premises at all times that the premises are in operation. The policy should include (but not necessarily be limited to) the following:

- i. Details as to how customer / staff egress at the premises shall be managed to minimise causing nuisance.
 - ii. Details of public transport in the vicinity and how customers will be advised in respect of it.
 - iii. Details of the management of taxis to and from the premises.
 - iv. Details of the management of any 'winding down' period at the premises.
 - v. Details of the use of security and stewarding in respect of managing customer dispersal from the premises.
 - vi. Details of road safety in respect of customers leaving the premises.
 - vii. Details of the management of ejections from the premises.
 - viii. Details as to how any physical altercations at the premises are to be managed.
 - ix. Details of how refuse / waste in the local vicinity arising through the operation of the premises will be cleared up (e.g. flyer clean up, post event clean up).
7. That a dispersal policy will be implemented and maintained to assist with patrons leaving the premises in an orderly and safe manner and all relevant staff will be trained in the contents of this policy and made aware of any changes. A record of this training will be kept including the date and the trainees name and made available for inspection when requested. A copy of the dispersal policy shall be made available to police officers and authorised council officers.
8. That an incident book/incident recording system shall be kept at the premises to record details of any of the following occurrences at the premises:
- i. Instances of anti-social or disorderly behaviour or Violence
 - ii. Calls to the police or fire brigade
 - iii. Abuse of staff and/or customers
 - iv. Ejections of people from the premises
 - v. Visits to the premises by the local authority, police or fire brigade
 - vi. Refused sales of alcohol
 - vii. Any malfunction in respect of the CCTV system
 - viii. Any other relevant incidents.
9. That the incident book/incident recording system shall record the time, date, location, and description of each incident as well as the printed name of the person reporting the incident and any action taken in respect of the incident.

The incident book/incident recording system shall be available and accessible at the premises at all times that the premises are in use in accordance with this licence and shall be made available immediately to Police and responsible authority officers upon request. A record of the preceding 12 months' incidents shall be available at the premises at any time. That all Digital records of training and/or logs shall be made immediately available to Police officers and authorised council officers.

10. That the premises must have a welfare and vulnerability policy and all staff must receive this training. All new staff must receive this training before starting their role and all staff must have refresher training every 12 months. All training must be recorded and these records must be available on immediate request by responsible authority officers. That all digital records of training and/or logs shall be made immediately available to police officers and authorised council officers.
11. That the venue shall support "Ask for Angela" or another similar safety initiative and posters shall be displayed on the premises. All staff shall be trained in "Ask Angela" or a similar safety initiative and a record of this training shall be kept on the premises and made available for inspection immediately to responsible authority officers upon request. That all digital records of training and/or logs shall be made immediately available to police officers and authorised council officers.
12. That customers shall use no outside area other than those who temporarily leave the premises to smoke a cigarette at the front of the premises with no more than 4 people permitted to smoke at one any time. The Staff shall monitor the area and ensure patrons do not not obstruct the highway or cause any disturbance to their neighbours.
13. That no alcohol or glassware shall be removed from the premises at any time.
14. That the supply of alcohol on the premises shall only be to a person seated taking a hot table meal there and for consumption by such a person as ancillary to their meal only.
15. That all licensable activities shall cease 30 mins before the terminal hour.
16. That there shall be no vertical drinking in the premises.
17. That the licensee shall risk assess the requirement for additional SIA door supervisors and implement accordingly. This assessment shall be in written format and available for inspection by to police officers and authorised council officers.

18. That there shall be no music led events be that live or recorded inclusive of DJs at the venue.
19. There shall be a zero tolerance drugs and weapons policy shall be undertaken at the premises.
 - a) Anybody found with / using drugs and / or weapons will be ejected from the premises and shall not be admitted to the premises again.
 - b) The details of any person found dealing drugs or using weapons will be taken (if possible) and given to the police.
 - c) Any person who is suspected of having drugs on their person will be asked to consent to a search, and should they refuse the search that person shall be ejected from the premises.
 - d) This policy shall be made available immediately on the request of police officers and authorised council officers.
20. That clearly legible signage shall be prominently displayed where it can easily be seen and read by customers in the premises' toilet(s) advising to the effect that the taking of illegal drugs will not be tolerated at the premises. These notices shall be kept free from obstructions at all times.
21. That no spirits (liquids containing more than 20% ABV) are to be sold by the bottle or half bottle.
22. That the accommodation limit shall not exceed 35

Recommendations by the licensing sub-committee

1. That wherever possible, the applicant agrees to endeavour not to use single use plastics.

Reasons

The licensing sub-committee convened to consider an application for a new premises licence in respect of the premises known as La Hueca Limited – 220 Old Kent Road, London SE1 5UB.

The licensing sub-committee heard from the licensing officer who outlined the nature of the application. He confirmed that the premises was not located within a CIA and that the hours applied for, were inconsistent with Southwark's statement of licensing policy 2021-2026 in that the terminal hour exceeded the recommended closing hour by thirty minutes.

The officer went on to state that the only objecting responsible authority, the Metropolitan Police Service, had conciliated after the applicant had agreed to abide by a number of conditions put forward by it.

The remaining objector, other person one, purported to be the applicant's landlord. He stated that the applicant did not have his permission to apply for a licence. Other person one went on to object on the grounds of public nuisance, disorder, and the impact the grant of the licence would have on the surrounding area. Their representations did not provide evidence or an explanation of how nuisance or disorder would or had occurred, nor did they explain how the grant of a licence would impact the surrounding area.

The licensing officer expressed the view that the representations in substance were akin to a civil dispute and only just met the criteria for a relevant representation. On that basis, the matter was referred to the licensing sub-committee for determination in accordance with Section 182 guidance.

The licensing officer informed the committee that he had spoken with the applicant that morning. The applicant confirmed he would not attend the meeting.

As the other person objector did not attend the meeting, the licensing sub-committee retired to consider the application on the papers.

Having considered the objections, the licensing sub-committee were satisfied that there was insufficient evidence before it, to conclude that the grant of a licence would cause public nuisance, enhance crime and or disorder or impact the surrounding area.

The licensing sub-committee considered and was content with the conditions agreed with the Metropolitan Police Service. It was also satisfied that exceeding the terminal hour by 30 minutes in this instance, would be consistent with most other establishments of that nature in that area. On that basis, the application was granted.

The licensing sub-committee recommended the premises endeavour not to use single use plastics wherever possible in accordance with Southwark's statement of licensing policy.

In reaching its decision, the licensing sub-committee had regard to all the relevant considerations, the four licensing objectives and considered that its decision was appropriate and proportionate in all the circumstances.

Appeal rights

The applicant may appeal against any decision:

- a. To impose conditions on the licence
- b. To exclude a licensable activity or refuse to specify a person as premises supervisor.

Any person who made relevant representations in relation to the application who desire to contend that:

- a. The licence ought not to be been granted; or
- b. That on granting the licence, the licensing authority ought to have imposed different or additional conditions to the licence, or ought to have modified them in a different way

may appeal against the decision.

Any appeal must be made to the Magistrates' Court for the area in which the premises are situated. Any appeal must be commenced by notice of appeal given by the appellant to the justices' clerk for the Magistrates' Court within the period of 21 days beginning with the day on which the appellant was notified by the licensing authority of the decision appealed against.

The meeting ended at 10.45am.

CHAIR:

DATED: